

Laboratory Brief 3: Category Learning

Due: Thursday, November 5 at 11:59 PM

Value: 55 points

Format: Individual laboratory brief

Purpose

Compare how quickly learners acquire a verbalizable category rule versus an information-integration category.

Your task

- Graph accuracy across six training blocks for both category structures.
- Identify the first block in which each condition reaches at least 75% accuracy.
- Describe whether improvement is gradual or abrupt and relate this pattern to explicit and procedural learning systems.
- Explain why order, feedback, or item similarity could provide an alternative explanation.

Provided evidence or data

Training block	Rule-based accuracy	Integration accuracy
1	.56	.53
2	.64	.57
3	.76	.61
4	.84	.68
5	.89	.74
6	.92	.81

Submit

- 700-900 word PDF brief with one figure and one threshold calculation.

Grading criteria

Criterion	Pts	Full-credit evidence
Question and variables	8	States the question and operational definitions accurately.
Analysis	15	Calculations are correct, transparent, and tied to the supplied data.
Figure or table	10	Presents a labeled, readable display with units and an informative caption.
Interpretation	15	Explains the pattern using the relevant theory without overstating causality.
Limitations and form	7	Identifies a meaningful limitation and follows the brief format.

Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.